Removing the Glove

By Clarence Coo

Suggested Roles: ACTOR 1: *Louis, Support Group Members, Newscaster's Voice, Disagreer's Voice, Dad, Mom, Jessica, Mark*
ACTOR 2: *Will, Protestor's Voice, Cindy*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

(WILL walks to some empty chairs up Centerstage. He sits in one of them. The other chairs soon fill up with people of various ages and genders. A middle-aged man, LOUIE, stands in front of them. LIGHTS come up on the SUPPORT GROUP.)

LOUIE: Hi. I'm Louie and I'm left-handed!

SUPPORT GROUP MEMBERS: AND THAT'S OKAY!

LOUIE: So are there any new members today? *(everyone looks at WILL who appears to be very intimidated.)*

WILL: Uh… me. I'm Will.

SUPPORT GROUP MEMBERS: HI, WILL! YOU'RE OKAY!

WILL: I saw the ad for your support group in the paper and I thought I'd stop by for a meeting. *(weakly)* Okay… I'm left-handed.

LOUIE: What was that?

WILL: *(stronger)* I'm left-handed.

LOUIE: What was that?

WILL: *(shouting)* I'M LEFT-HANDED! *(pause)* You know, that's the first time I've said those words aloud.

LOUIE: Congratulations, Will. You've taken your first step in being honest with yourself. The first step in being honest with the world. The first step in… *(raises his left hand)* Removing the Glove! *(in an overly dramatic fashion, pantomimes removing a glove from his hand. Cheers follow)*

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WILL: *(very intimidated)* Removing the glove. Okay. So, what is that like?

LOUIE: Removing the glove is removing the lie that you have lived for other people. Removing the glove means doing what is truly natural for you. It means to be yourself. Because you, Will are okay.

WILL: But… but… then people will know.

LOUIE: That's right, Will. People will know. Because you tell them. Not just in your actions, but in your words. It's better for your friends and family to know from you before they find out for themselves. You HAVE to tell them.

WILL: I'm going to *(raises his left hand)* remove the glove! *(removes an imaginary glove over dramatically)* I'm going to start with my family at the dinner table. Then I'll tell my friends at school. I'm committed to this. I just can't live my life like this. I can't hide anymore. I'm ready.

INTRODUCTION

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NEWSCASTER'S VOICE: Left-handed activists are staging another protest in front of the White House this afternoon. They demanded the passage of a new civil rights bill which would ban job discrimination based on hand dominance. We take you there now, live.

PROTESTER'S VOICE: *(sound of protesters chanting is heard in the background)* The fact that I am left-handed does not make me any less of a worker, or a person, than anyone else. I was born left-handed and I am proud. . .

DISAGREER'S VOICE: Left-handedness is a sick, depraved practice. That's why it's called LEFT-handedness -- because it is not RIGHT. God intended for us all to use our right hand. You, sir, are a pervert. *(cheering from the bystanders; shouts of "pervert" and "lefty" are hurled at the protesters. Dad shuts off television and addresses the family)*

DAD: I read in the paper today that they're going to let left-handers in the military.

MOM: Oh, yes. The new "Don't Ask, Don't Tell" policy. It was the President's decision.

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CINDY: Well, why would the President be catering to the interests of those left-handers? *(pause)* Wait, you don't think that the President . . .

DAD: Cindy, don't be silly. If the President was left-handed, he would have never been elected to office.

CINDY: Have you heard about all those left-handed priests and left-handed Boy Scout leaders? The world just isn't safe anymore. *(remembering, then getting choked with excitement.)* Oh, I can't believe I forgot to tell you guys. George Bradshaw removed the glove about being ambidextrous at the game last night.

MOM: George Bradshaw . . . isn't he the school's biggest football star?

CINDY: Sure is. No one ever suspected HIM. I mean, George Bradshaw was a football player. He never seemed peculiar. It's not like he was one of those Drama Lefties. . . He got kicked off the team.

DAD: I tell ya, kids, those left-handed people are everywhere these days. You've got to be real careful. Speaking of football, Will, why didn't you try out for the team at school? You could have been the quarterback, like I was when I was your age.

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(WILL address the audience; his family and two friends are listening intently)

WILL: Hey guys. Can I talk to you for a moment? I've been meaning to tell you something that's been burning inside of me for a long time. I've tried to deny it myself—but I just can't. I've faced the fact that it's true and I hope that you can, too. I'm left-handed. I can still remember my first left-handed experience. I was doing my math homework one day, when my mind started to wander to other things. I looked at my pencil and thought, "What would it be like to put it in my left hand?" So, then I took my apprehensive fingers and wrapped it gently around that hard, wooden number 2. And I slid it across that piece of paper like there was no tomorrow. And it felt so good. So good. It was ecstasy! Sorry, but this thing I am -- left-handed -- it doesn't change who I am. I hope you realize that. Because I've always been that way. And I guess I always will. Please try to understand? Please?

MOM: Jim, turn around right now. Jim, he's our son.

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DAD: Well, he can be YOUR son because MY son was right-handed.

CINDY: *(on the phone)* Yes, my own brother, first George Bradshaw; now my own brother. . .

DAD: My own son had possibilities of becoming a quarterback. Not with a left-hand. He'd be a laughingstock. He'd be a disgrace. They'd never let him into the locker room. I can just picture it now. It's after a game and he's in there showering with them. He reaches out to turn the hot water on and because he can't control himself he . . . *(disgusted.)* turns the COLD water on!

CINDY: *(still on the phone.)* Yeah, I know . . . It's like they're coming out from everywhere these days . . . Yeah . . . I know. It's like earthworms after a rainstorm . . .

DAD: I can't believe this. Do you know what this means? This means I've failed as a parent.

WILL: Dad, please turn around

DAD: I won't until you apologize for lying to us about being left-handed.

WILL: Dad, I'm not lying to you. I keep trying to tell you that.

DAD: So, if you're not lying, why did you choose this lifestyle?

WILL: Dad, I didn't choose it.

DAD: I'm disappointed in you, Will. Don't you know how wrong this is? This is the most sinful and morally reprehensible thing you could do. Don't you understand why left-handedness is wrong, Will? It's completely unnatural! I don't want to ever speak to you again.

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WILL: Jessica, we need to talk.

JESSICA: I don't have to talk to you. You're left-handed now. Next thing you know, you'll be cutting up paper with special scissors. Then you'll join one of those leftist organizations and march down the streets of Washington, D.C. proclaiming your handedness in front of nationwide TV.

WILL: Jessica . . .

JESSICA: *(walks off in a state of shock)* Hey Ted, would you like to cut some paper with me? I have some very nice scissors! Ha ha ha. Ha ha ha." *(MARK enters)*

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WILL: Mark. I'm glad you're here. Look, I'm really sorry if . . .

MARK: Oh, sorry huh? I know the trick you're playing. Next, you'll suggest we shake hands and make up. But, of course, you'll want to shake with our LEFT hands. Wasn't that the plan, eh? But I'm ahead of your game, you little deviant. What are you looking at? You're looking at my left hand, aren't you? You are! I saw you, so stop it. Stop looking! *(hysterical, as he runs off)* Aaaaaaaaaaah!

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WILL: I thought removing the glove would make me feel better. *(walks over to the dinner table.)*

DAD: You're back! *(gives WILL a big hug.)*

WILL: Dad, you talked to me!

DAD: It's going to be okay, Will. It's going to be okay! Everything will turn out just fine. *(removes a brochure from his pocket)* Cindy gave this to me. There's this nice psychiatrist in the city named Dr. Fussbaum. And this guy can really help you. He says that with two years of therapy and electroshock treatment, you'll be as good as normal! Isn't that great? Thank you, modern science! Thank you! *(one more hug then WILL steps downstage and speaks to the support group)*

WILL: You know, removing the glove has really taught me a lesson. So, I thought that I should tell you something that I've never told anyone before. Well . . . I'm a Pisces.

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Clarence Coo
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AWARD HISTORY

2003 National Qualifier
2008 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier – MS
2020 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

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